

HACKER HOUSE



SELECTION FRAMEWORK & TIMELINE

The Road to 247

How builders earn a seat at Hacker House Goa 2026. The trials,
the criteria, and the journey to the beach.

THE MODEL

A rolling challenge, not a waiting list.

Everyone builds. No one is just watching.

Instead of filling one application and waiting for the result, you earn your spot by completing different skill-based tasks. New tasks open one after another. If you miss one, you can still try the next. Keep participating until your whole team is in.

There are **two stages**.

- **Open Trials (August):** Anyone can join. These tasks are based only on your skills and performance.
- **Partner Trials (September):** These are with our partners. They look for builders who match their goals and needs.

Getting selected in a trial does not guarantee your seat. Your seat is confirmed only after the **RSVP & Stake** process in late September, when every member of your team confirms.

THE TIMELINE AT A GLANCE

PHASE	WHEN	PURPOSE
Open Trials	August 2026	Skill-based challenges open to everyone.
Partner Trials	September 2026	Selection based on each partner's requirements and interests.
RSVP & Stake	Late September	Final confirmation of your team's participation.
Residency	28–31 October 2026	247 builders come together to build, ship, and launch projects in Goa.

STAGE ONE · AUGUST

Open Trials

The skill-based stage, open to everyone. Tasks open one by one across August. Each task is separate, has its own deadline, and offers a set number of in-person seats. No task is tied to any partner.

HOW A TEAM CLEARS AN OPEN TRIAL

- 1 Teams of one to three.** The team is the unit of selection. Solo builders are welcome too.
- 2 Everyone submits.** Each member completes and submits the same task on their own.
- 3 All or nothing.** A team is selected only when every member has submitted and passed.
- 4 Try as often as you like.** Missed a task? Try the next one. Keep going until you are in.

Every selected builder, not just team leads, has personally cleared a task. Quality is set at the door.

STAGE TWO · SEPTEMBER

Partner Trials

The partner stage. Tasks are shaped around specific partners, so each one arrives at the residency with a group of builders matched to what they care about.

- **Their own deadlines.** Each Partner Trial runs on its own timeline.
- **The same standard.** Every member still submits their own task.
- **A second door.** Builders not yet selected in Open Trials get a fresh way in.

WHAT WE LOOK FOR

Criteria & your seat

Selection is based on merit across both stages. How you perform on the task is the main signal; the rest adds context.

WHAT WE LOOK AT	WHAT IT MEANS
Proof of building	Shipped projects, repositories, hackathon results. What you have built matters more than what you say.
Task performance	How you actually solve the task. This is the main signal.
Clear thinking	The ability to reason about problems worth solving. You do not need a finished idea to apply.
Drive to be there	A real wish to take part. With limited seats, this makes a difference.

RSVP & STAKE

Being selected does not confirm your seat. In the last week of September, selected builders confirm by staking. A team's seat is locked only once **every member** has staked. This turns interest into a real commitment, keeps the standard the same for everyone, and gives partners a reliable headcount before October.

SEATS & THE HYBRID OPTION

The residency is built for 247 in-person builders. That number can grow with demand and partner interest. Where it fits, some tracks may open to remote builders. This hybrid option will be announced when it goes live.